

1-800-GOT-SOAP — IVR / Phone Script

Production draft · got soap? × Concerned Women Against Axe Abuse

The concept: The caller dials a fun campaign number and slowly falls through the floor into CWAAA. Most callers hear the greeting, laugh, and hang up — they got the joke. The caller who keeps pressing buttons descends into something a little too official, a little too monitored.

Casting — this is the whole trick:

- **VOICE A — “The Campaign.”** Warm, glossy, a smiling cologne-ad voiceover. Sounds like a fragrance commercial. Used for the got soap? layer.
- **VOICE B — “Compliance.”** Flat, pleasant, corporate-automated — the exact too-cheerful cadence of every toll-free system that won’t let you reach a human. Used for the CWAAA layer.

The drop from Voice A to Voice B is the seam. The wrongness is in the delivery, so the direction notes matter as much as the words.

MAIN GREETING

[VOICE A — warm, glossy, smiling. The last two lines are delivered exactly as warmly as the first — that’s what makes them land wrong.]

“Thank you for calling **got soap?** — where clean is sexy, and effort is a fragrance. Your call is important to us. It’s important to *her*, too. Please listen carefully, as our menu options have changed. They change often. We change often.”

MAIN MENU

[VOICE B — pleasant corporate automation. Note: no option 5 or 6 is announced. Those are hidden.]

“For campaign information and PSAs, press 1. To take the Sniff Test, press 2. To take the Lather Pledge, press 3. To report a low-effort man in your life, press 4. To speak with a Field Assessor, press 0.”

BRANCH 1 — PSAs

[VOICE A — glossy, still fun. This branch stays light on purpose; it's the "safe" one.]

"**got soap?** is a public service announcement for the chronically unwashed. Five posters. One demand. Take the shower. Visit got soap dot app to see the full campaign — then send it to the man who needs it. You know the one. *[beat]* We know him too. To return to the main menu, press star."

BRANCH 2 — The Sniff Test

[VOICE A for the first two lines, then VOICE B slides in on "We have your number." The handoff between voices is the tilt.]

A: "The Sniff Test is a brief field assessment. Answer honestly — your group chat already has. Question one: When did you last use soap? Not body spray. Soap." *[long pause — too long]* **B:** "Take your time. We have your number. We'll wait." **A:** "Complete the full assessment at got soap dot app, slash, sniff test. To return to the main menu, press star."

BRANCH 3 — The Lather Pledge

[VOICE B, but slower — reverent, almost liturgical. Deliver it like an oath of office, not a joke.]

"To take the Lather Pledge, repeat after the tone. *[tone]* I do solemnly swear: To lather daily. To retire body spray as a shower substitute. To respect the loofah in word and deed. And never again to mistake deodorant for divine intervention. *[beat]* Your pledge has been recorded. It is binding. Lather. Rinse. Respect."

BRANCH 4 — Report a Low-Effort Man

[The dark one. VOICE B throughout. Starts helpful and encouraging, then the temperature drops one degree at a time. Never raise the voice — the flatter, the worse.]

"You've reached the Office of Lather Compliance. Reporting a low-effort man is a courageous act. You are doing the right thing. Please state his full name and last known location after the tone." *[tone · beat]* "Thank you. A field assessor has been assigned."

Please remain on the line, and one of our agents will assist you."

[HOLD — a few seconds of pleasant hold music, then VOICE B returns, flatter, more cheerful:]

"All of our agents are currently in the field. Your call is important to us. If you are disconnected, you will receive a call back as soon as possible."

[beat — then the turn:]

"There's no need to provide your number. We have it. We've had it since you dialed. Please continue to hold. Someone is already on their way."

[Loop the hold music. There is no live agent. There was never going to be one.]

BRANCH 0 — "Speak With a Field Assessor"

[VOICE B — pleasant, patient, and quietly merciless. This weaponizes the no-human-representative hell everyone already hates.]

"You've requested a live representative. We admire your optimism. Your estimated wait time is... *[pause]* ...indefinite. While you wait, please enjoy the knowledge that you could have simply taken the shower. Please hold."

[Hold music resumes. Every ~30 seconds, VOICE B interrupts:]

"Thank you for your continued patience. It has been noted. Everything is noted."

HIDDEN BRANCH — Any Un-Offered Key (suggest: 6)

[The Easter egg. Rewards the caller who presses a button that isn't on the menu. VOICE B — almost warm, which is worse.]

"That option is not on the menu. But you pressed it anyway. *[beat]* That tells us something about you. Something we've written down. Welcome. You're one of us now. ... Or you will be. Please take the shower."

VOICEMAIL / AFTER HOURS

[VOICE B. Deliver the sign-off — "Lather. Rinse. Respect." — with the warmth of a customer-service farewell. That's the button.]

"The Office of Lather Compliance is closed for its daily decontamination cycle. Please leave your name, your number — though we likely already have it — and your confession after the tone. *[tone]* Your confession has been logged. A field assessor will be assigned. Lather. Rinse. Respect."

Production notes

- **Two voices, cast deliberately.** If budget is one voice actor, have them build two distinct characters (bright cologne-VO vs. flat automation) rather than flattening to one — the contrast carries the horror.
- **Keep the first 8 seconds funny.** Most callers judge fast. The greeting must earn a laugh before the descent begins, or they hang up before the payoff.
- **Silence is a tool.** The pauses marked *[beat]* and *[long pause]* are where the wrongness breathes. Don't rush them.
- **On the printed card:** "Operators are standing by." (They are not.)